

THE
LANGUAGE OF FLOWERS.

SPRING.

MARCH.

GRASSES (*Gramina*). Utility.



HERE is there any plant more useful than the grass of the meadow? It grows without care or culture, all over the earth; sustaining the life of all the animals most serviceable to man. Botanists tell us that more than three hundred varieties of grass exist. Many of them have exceedingly graceful and beautiful blossoms.

WEeping Willow (*Salix Babylonica*). Melancholy.

The common willow is sacred to forsaken lovers ; but this graceful tree, whose branches seem to droop with an eternal weight of regret, is by universal consent appropriated to the graveyard. There, early in spring, its silvery, flexile branches wave over the resting-places of those dear to us, and seem to murmur continually, with Lafontaine, —

“ Absence is the greatest of all evils.”

HORSE-CHESTNUT (*Æsculus hippocastanum*). Luxury.

This gorgeous tree bursts into leaf and bloom with incredible rapidity on the return of spring. When it is growing alone, nothing can equal the symmetry of its pyramidal form, the richness of its foliage, and its superb clusters of flowers. The fruit, however, is bitter, and the wood of little value.

LILAC (*Syringa vulgaris*). First emotion of love.

“ O Lilac, in whose purple well
Youth, *in perpetuo*, doth dwell,
My fancy feels thy fragrant spell.

“ Of all that morning dews do feed —
All flowers of garden, field, or mead —
Thou art the first in childhood’s creed.

“ And, e’en to me, thy breath in spring
Hath power a little while to bring
Back to my heart its blossoming.”

T. W. Parsons.

Van Spaendonck let his brush fall before a bunch of lilacs. Nature seems indeed to have made every cluster

perfect. Around each mass of bloom the light plays and is decomposed into a thousand varying shades, which, all melting into one tint, make that happy harmony which dazzles the beholder and drives the painter to despair.

“The lilac, various in array, now white,
Now sanguine, and her beauteous head now set
With purple spikes pyramidal, as if, studions of ornaments,
Yet unresolved which hues she most approved,
She chose them all.”

Cowper.

The lilac symbolizes the first emotions of love, because its tender green, its flexible shoots, and its abundant flowers, with their tender and varied colors, all recall those celestial emotions which lend to youth a divine grace.

ALMOND (*Amygdalus communis*). Heedlessness.

Emblem of heedlessness, the almond answers first to the call of spring, and covers itself with a shower of blossoms, like rosy snow, while all the shrubbery is yet leafless. Virgil makes it prophesy of the harvest to come. Fable gives the almond tree this origin. Demophoön, son of Theseus and Phædra, returning from the siege of Troy, was thrown by a tempest on the coast of Thrace, where the beautiful Phyllis then reigned. The young queen welcomed the prince, loved him, and made him her husband. Recalled to Athens by the death of his father, Demophoön promised Phyllis to

come back in a month, and fixed the moment of his return. The tender Phyllis counted every instant of his absence, and when the long-desired day at last arrived, she ran nine times to the shore: but, having lost all hope, believing herself forsaken, she fell there, dead of grief, and was changed into an almond tree. Three months after, Demophoön returned: disconsolate at his loss, he offered a sacrifice on the sea-shore, to appease the *manes* of his beloved. She seemed sensible of his repentance and return, for the almond tree suddenly put forth flowers, proving by this last effort that death itself could not change her.

PERIWINKLE (*Vinca minor*). Sweet memories.

The periwinkle has green, firm, glossy leaves, which, growing on long, trailing stems, weave a fairy net over the grass to imprison the pretty blue flowers which peep out here and there. This plant is dedicated to lasting happiness; its color is that preferred by friendship, and it was for J. J. Rousseau the emblem of the sweetest remembrances.

TULIP (*Tulipa gesneriana*). Declaration of love.

The tulip is a native of Asia, and some writers claim that its name arose from its resemblance to a turban, though Thomas Miller says, "Few know that there is a beautiful fragrant yellow tulip which grows wild

in our own pastoral England. It gives pleasure to me to know that we are neither indebted to Turks nor turbans for the origin of this splendid flower, which was, no doubt, more plentiful in the days of our old Elizabethan poets, and which is mentioned in Ben Jonson's 'Pan's Anniversary' by the very name it still bears." In the East, when a young man presents one to his mistress, it signifies, by its general color, that he is on fire with her beauty, and by its black centre, that his heart is burned to a coal. The Turks almost idolize this flower; and every year, in the seraglio of the Sultan, the Feast of Tulips is celebrated with the utmost splendor. In Europe, also, tulips have had their adorers. Between the years 1644 and 1647, tulips rose to incredible prices in Holland, and enriched many speculators. Those who, for want of ready money, could not engage in this trade, exchanged houses and lands for bulbs. One variety, the Viceroy, is said to have been sold as high as ten thousand dollars! This extraordinary traffic was at last checked by a law that no tulip, or other flower, should be sold for a sum exceeding one hundred and seventy-five dollars.

BUCKBEAN (*Menyanthes trifoliata*). Calmness, repose.

Along that lake whose silvery waters reflect a cloudless sky, do you see those clusters, as white as snow? A light pink just tinges the reverse of these lovely

flowers, and a tuft of very delicate filaments of dazzling whiteness escapes from their alabaster cups. If you have once seen this plant, balancing gently on the edge of the water, you can never forget its elegance and grace. The bog-bean, or water-trefoil, as it is sometimes called, never blooms in stormy weather; it expands only in a calm day.





APRIL.

HAWTHORN (*Crataegus*). Hope.



OUR old poets, as if despairing to find a fitting name for this fragrant blossom, have called it May; for to them that word recalled the season of poetry, the month of flowers, and was fraught with associations of all that is bright and beautiful on the earth." The Troglydites, who recalled the golden age by their simple manners, smilingly covered those whom death took from them with branches of hawthorn; for they regarded death as the dawn of a life in which they should part no more. In Athens, young maidens carried boughs of hawthorn at the weddings of their companions; the

altar of Hymen was lighted by torches made of the wood of this shrub, which, as we see, has always been the emblem of hope.

PRIMROSE (*Primula vulgaris*, or *acaulis*). Modest worth.

English literature is filled with allusions to this flower. The primrose, cowslip, polyanthus, and auricula are all members of the same floral family.

“Pale primroses,
That die unmarried ere they can behold
Bright Phœbus in his strength.”—*Shakspeare*.

“Bring the rathe primrose, that forsaken dies.”—*Milton*.

“The primrose, tenant of the glade,
Emblem of virtue in the shade.”—*J. Mayne*, 1609.

MYRTLE (*Myrtus communis*). Love.

The oak from all time was consecrated to Jupiter, the laurel to Apollo, the olive to Minerva, and the myrtle to Venus. In Rome the first temple of this goddess was surrounded by a grove of myrtles; in Greece she was adored under the name of Myrtea or Murtia. When she appeared rising from the sea, the Hours went to meet her, and presented to her a thousand-colored scarf and a myrtle garland. After her victory over Pallas and Juno, she was crowned with myrtle by the Loves. Surprised one day by a troop of Satyrs, she took refuge behind a bush of myrtle: it was also with branches of this tree that she avenged herself on the audacious Psyche, who had dared to compare her charms with

those of the immortal beauty. The *Flora Domestica* says, "Myrtle was the symbol of authority for magistrates at Athens; bloodless victors were crowned with myrtle." Spears, too, were made of its wood.

"The war from stubborn myrtle shafts receives."—*Dryden's Virgil*.

The Arabs have recorded an ancient tradition that Adam bore in his hand a sprig of myrtle when he was driven out from the garden of Paradise. It was formerly much used in medicine and cookery, and also to flavor wines. It flourishes in warm climates, near the sea-coast.

ACANTHUS (*Acanthus mollis*). Art.

The acanthus delights in warm countries and the banks of great rivers. Pliny speaks of its value for decorative purposes. The ancients ornamented their furniture, their vases, and their valuable garments with its beautifully cut leaves. The robe of Helen was bordered by a garland of acanthus in relief. Virgil tells us also of a vase from the hand of Alcimedon, adorned with foliage imitated from the acanthus. This charming model of the arts has become their emblem. If anything is opposed to the acanthus, we see it redouble its forces, and grow with new vigor. Thus genius rises and increases by the very obstacles which seemed insurmountable. It is related that the architect Callimachus, passing by the tomb of a young girl who died within the

year, on the eve of a happy marriage, was moved by a tender pity, and approached to throw flowers on it. But an offering had preceded his. The nurse of the young girl, taking the veil and flowers which should have adorned her on her wedding day, put them in a little basket; then, having placed it beside the tomb on a plant of acanthus, she covered it with a broad tile. The next spring the acanthus leaves had surrounded the basket; but, stopped by the edges of the tile, they bent back and rounded gracefully towards their extremities. Callimachus, surprised at this rural decoration, which seemed the work of the weeping Graces, made of it the capital of the Corinthian column.

BUGLOSS (*Anchusa officinalis*.) Falsehood.

La Bruyère, the most *spirituel* of French moralists, said, "If women were naturally what they become by art, if they should lose in a moment all the freshness of their complexion, if their faces were as glowing or as leady as they make them by the rouge and the paint which they use, they would be inconsolable." This truth appears incontestable; and yet, from north to south, from east to west, among savage or polished nations, this strange taste for painting is universal. Dupperron relates how a young savage, wishing to attract his attention, took a bit of coal and went to pound it in a corner, then, having rubbed her cheeks with it, returned with a triumphant air, as if this had rendered the effect

of her charms more sure. Castellan, speaking of a Greek princess whom he painted, describes her thus : “ Her black eyes, well shaped, and on a level with her head, had the brilliancy of diamonds, but her stained eyelids spoiled their expression. Her eyebrows, joined by a pencilled line, gave a kind of hardness to her look. Her mouth, very small and highly colored, might have been embellished by a smile, but I never had the happiness of seeing one. Her cheeks were covered with a very deep red, and crescent-shaped patches disfigured her face.”

Bugloss has been made the emblem of falsehood, because its root is used in the composition of several kinds of paints. That of which it is the basis is perhaps the oldest and least dangerous of all. But nothing can imitate the natural blush of modesty, and art destroys it irreparably. If we wish to please long, if we wish to please always, let us discard falsehood from our hearts, our lips, and our faces, repeating with the poet, —

“ Rien n'est beau que le vrai, le vrai seul est aimable.”

REST-HARROW (*Ononis spinosa*). Obstacles.

This plant sometimes stops the labors of the husbandman by its tough network of roots. With its pretty papilionaceous pink flowers, its long thorns, and deeply-struck roots, it is the siren of the fields, and the emblem of the obstacles which vice opposes to virtue.

HONEYSUCKLE (*Lonicera*). Bonds of love.

“Bid her steal into the pleachéd bower,
Where honeysuckles, ripened by the sun,
Forbid the sun to enter—like favorites
Made proud by princes, that advance their pride
Against that power that bred it.”

Shakspeare.

The poets have repeatedly celebrated this delightful flower under the name of woodbine.

The delicious bank in *Midsummer Night's Dream* was

“Quite overcanopied with lush woodbine.”

The opposite attributes of inconstancy and fidelity have been ascribed to the honeysuckle by two poets, but the following lines are most certainly a slander on this sweet flower—

“Inconstant woodbine, wherefore rove
With gadding stem about my bower?
Why, with my darling myrtle wove,
In bold defiance mock my power?”

Carew.

Rather let us believe with good old Dan Chaucer, in the *Floure and the Leafe*,—

“And those that were chapélets on their hede,
Of fresh woodhind, be such as uever were
To love untrue in word, in thought, in dede,
But ay stedfast, ne for plesaunce ne fere,
Tho' that they shudde their hertis all to tere,
Would never flit, but evir were stedfast,
Till that ther livis these assunder brast.”

Sometimes we see a young honeysuckle lovingly wind its slender arms around the knotty trunk of an old oak: one would say that this weak shrub wished, springing aloft, to surpass the king of the forests in height; but

soon, as if its efforts were vain, it falls gracefully down again, and crowns him with perfumed festoons. Thus Love sometimes unites a timid girl to a proud warrior. Unhappy Desdemona! the admiration of strength and courage, and the feeling of helplessness, attached thy heart to the terrible Othello; but jealousy struck thee in the very arms which should have protected thee. And thou, gentle and humble La Vallière, the love of the greatest monarch alone could subjugate thy poor heart, and draw it away from virtue. Poor vine! the wind of inconstancy soon deprived thee of that dear prop; but thou didst never trail on the ground — thy heart, raising its affections to heaven, carried its tender homage to Him who alone is worthy of eternal love.

3 *





M A Y .

LILY OF THE VALLEY (*Convallaria majalis*). Return of
happiness.



LOOKING

now

among

the

broad green

leaves, with what

joy do we greet the little ivory bells of

“that modest, pale,
And sweetest nursling of the wood,
Which men call lily of the vale,
Because it dwells in lowly mood”!

Parsons.

"No flower amid the garden fairer grows
Than the sweet lily of the lowly vale."

Keats.

"The lily of the vale, whose virgin flower
Trembles at every breeze within its leafy bower."

Barton.

Wordsworth does not forget

"That shy plant, the lily of the vale,
That loves the ground, and from the sun withholds
Her pensive beauty, from the breeze her sweets."

And Thomson, in his Spring, bids us

"Seek the bank where flowering elders crowd,
Where, scattered wide, the lily of the vale
Its balmy essence breathes."

PRIVET (*Ligustrum vulgare*). Prohibition.

"Why," said a young matron to the venerable pastor of the village, "have you not planted a strong thorn hedge, instead of that flowering privet which encircles your garden?" The pastor replied, "When you forbid your child some dangerous pleasure, the prohibition is accompanied on your lips by a tender smile; your look is a caress; and if he rebels, your maternal hand immediately offers a plaything to console him: in like manner, the pastor's hedge ought to keep off the intrusive, and offer flowers even to those whom it repulses."

HEATH (*Erica*). Solitude.

The common heather, which grows so freely in Great Britain and Germany, is not found wild in this country.

The various elegant species which are found in conservatories are mostly natives of the Cape of Good Hope. Miller says, "The heath was well chosen as the emblem of solitude. It recalls many a wild landscape; the bleak, broad mountain side, which, throughout the long winter and the slow-opening spring, looked black and barren, till towards the end of summer, when it was clothed everywhere with the rich carpet of crimson and purple heather, looking from the distance as if a sunshine not of earth had come down and bathed the whole mountain steep in subdued and rosy light—it recalls vast plains of immeasurable extent; spots where lovers might sit and sigh away their souls in each other's arms without being disturbed by the foot of the solitary hunter."

POETS' NARCISSUS (*Narcissus poeticus*). Egotism.

This is the most beautiful of its family. A large flower, of pure white, slightly drooping, with a golden cup in the centre, which exhales a strong and pleasant odor. Every one knows the pretty story attached to it; so we confine ourselves to three extracts. Spenser, in describing a garden, says, —

"And round about grew every sort of floure,
To which sad lovers were transformed of yore;—
Foolish Narcisse, that likes the wat'ry shore."

"The pale nareissus, that with passion pure
Still feeds upon itself; but, newly blown,
The nymphs will pluck it from its tender stalk,
And say, 'Go, fool, and to thy image talk.'"

Lord Thurlow.

“On the bank a lonely flower he spied,
 A meek and forlorn flower, with nought of pride,
 Drooping its beauty o’er the watery clearness
 To woo its own sad image into nearness,
 Deaf to bright Zephyrus, it would not move,
 But still would seem to droop, to pine, to love.”
Keats.

LINDEN, or LIME (*Tilia*). Conjugal love.

“Come forth, and let us through our hearts receive
 The joy of verdure!—see, the honeyed lime
 Showers cool green light on banks where wild flowers weave
 Thick tapestry.”

Mrs. Hemans.

This favorite tree commemorates the beautiful story of Baucis and Philemon. Baucis was turned to a linden, and thus it stands now an emblem of the attributes and graces of a faithful wife. The foliage is very thick and verdant, and the effects of light and shade on it bewitching. The blossoms perfume all the surrounding air. It is a useful tree too; an infusion of its flowers makes a good *tisane*; its bark can be woven into a kind of cloth, and braided into ropes and hats. The Greeks made paper of it, resembling that from papyrus, and specimens made by our modern processes resemble white satin. Its wood furnishes the poorer classes in Europe with fuel, shoes, and furniture. The horse-chestnut and other trees have disputed its place in avenues and public promenades, but nothing can banish it.

STRAWBERRY (*Fragaria vesca*). Perfect excellence.

The illustrious Bernardin de St. Pierre conceived the project of writing a general history of nature, in imita-

tion of the ancient authors. A strawberry plant, which had chanced to grow over his window, turned him from this vast design: he observed this plant, and discovered so many wonders in it, that he clearly saw that the study of a single plant and its inhabitants was enough to fill a lifetime. He then renounced the ambitious title of his book, and contented himself with writing *Studies of Nature*. It is from this book that we must acquire a taste for observation; and it is there, above all, that we must read of the strawberry. All over the world this charming berry, which vies with the rosebud in freshness and perfume, delights the sight, the smell, the taste. It is a welcome luxury on the tables of the rich, and a feast for the children of the poor. The learned botanist Linnæus was cured of frequent attacks of the gout by the use of strawberries. The flowers are delicate and pretty; but who so barbarous as to pluck them?

THYME (*Thymus*). Activity.

“I know a bank whereon the wild thyme grows.”

How many diligent bees sing this song to each other, and swarm about the flowery, fragrant tufts! The Greeks regarded this herb as the symbol of activity; doubtless they had observed that its perfume, strengthening to the brain, is very salutary for old persons. Activity is a warlike virtue, and this is why ladies formerly often embroidered on the scarf of their knights a bee humming round a branch of thyme.

RED VALERIAN (*Valeriana rubra*). Readiness.

This is a native of the Alps. Its root is said to be an excellent remedy against most maladies engendered by luxury, and an infusion of it is strengthening to the eyes, and animating to the spirits. It blooms freely and is improved by culture, though our common valerian is perhaps more attractive, and equally useful. The odor of the root is very enticing to cats, and also, it is stated, to rats.





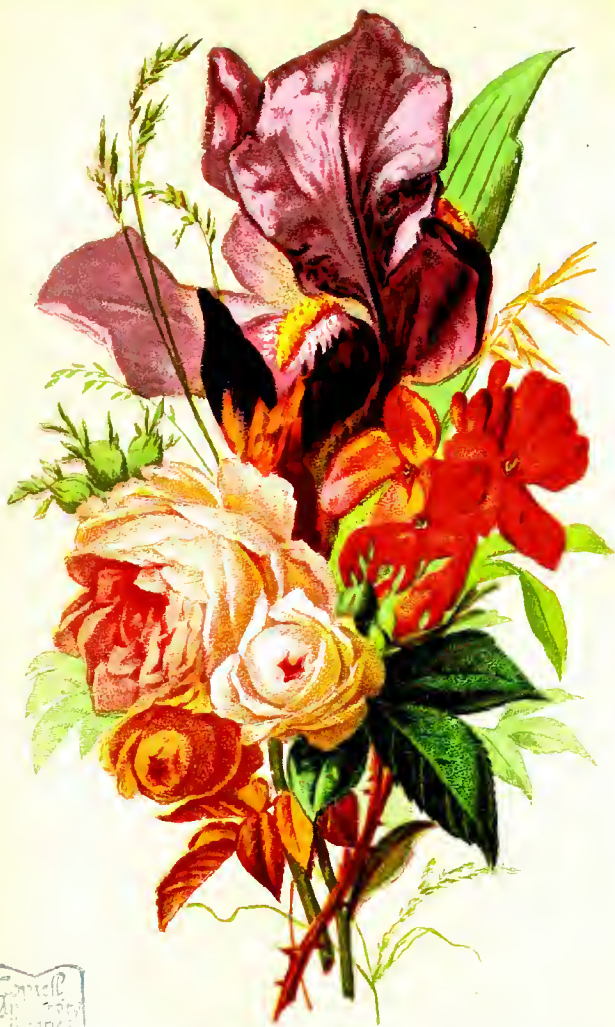
S U M M E R .

J U N E .

THE MONTH OF ROSES.



QUEEN of flowers, who that could sing has not sung thee, enchanting Rose? Yet no expression can exaggerate, or even do justice to, thy perfections. Perhaps the sweetest title of the Virgin Mother, to the heart of many a Catholic maiden, is the one of "Rosa Mystica." Among the Greeks and Romans the rose was the most conspic-



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uous ornament of every festival and every solemn sacrifice. Syria, Arabia, and Persia vie in their admiration of it. In the East, indeed, this fairest of flowers attains its greatest perfection. There is distilled the precious Attar, which makes it live forever.

"Ita breath
Is rich beyond the reat; and when it dies
It doth bequeath a charm to sweeten death."

Barry Cornwall.

The love of the nightingale for the rose is continually mentioned by the Eastern bards, and we find many allusions to it in our English rhymes. Moore says, —

"Though rich the spot
With every flower this earth has got,
What is it to the nightingale,
If there his darling rose is not?"

And Byron sings, —

"How welcome is each gentle air
That wakes and wafts the odors there!
For there the rose, o'er crag and vale,
Sultana of the nightingale,
The maid for whom his melody,
His thousand songs, is heard on high,
Blooms blushing to her lover's tale:
His queen, the garden's queen, his rose,
Unbent by winds, unchilled by snows,
Far from the winters of the west,
By every breeze and season bleat,
Returns the sweets by nature given
In softest incense back to heaven,
And grateful yields that smiling sky,
Her fairest hue and fragrant sigh."

In France there takes place annually a beautiful ceremony, which originated as follows: Saint Médard,

bishop of Noyon, born at Salency, of an illustrious family, instituted in his birthplace, in 532, a prize for virtue. This prize is a simple crown of roses; but all the young people of the village must acknowledge her who obtains it as the most worthy, modest, and virtuous. The sister of St. Médard was unanimously named the first *rosière*. She received her crown from the hands of its founder, and bequeathed it, with the example of her virtues, to posterity. Time, which has overturned so many empires, and broken the sceptre of so many kings and queens, has respected the rose crown of Salency. It has continued to pass from the hand of one protector and another to the brow of innocence.

Chaucer loved the rose, and crowned Venus with a garland "rosy white and redde." Spenser tells us that, in the contest of beauty, "a rosy girlond was the victor's meed." And after his description of fair Alma, in her rich array, he says, —

" Her yellow golden heare
Was trimly woven, and in tresses wrought;
Ne other tire she on her head did weare,
But crownéd with a garland of sweet *rosière*."

In many a festive scene, we find, as Sir Philip Sidney beautifully said, —

" A rosy garland and a weary head."

Thus the rose has often been used to "point a moral or adorn a tale." One of the most pleasing of Waller's poems is the well-known song, "Go, Lovely Rose." Middleton says, —

“ I never heard
Of any true affection, but ’twas nipt
With care, that like the caterpillar eats
The leaves of the spring’s sweetest book—the rose.”

Herrick sings,—

“Gather the rosebuds while ye may;
Old Time is still a flying;
And this same flower, that smiles to-day,
To-morrow will be dying.”

And holy George Herbert,—

“Sweet rose, whose hue, angry and brave,
Bids the rash gazer wipe his eye,
Thy root is ever in its grave,
And thou must die.”

The celebrated *Roman de la Rose*, the delight of the court of Philip the Fair, seems to have been written only to teach us how dangerous it is to listen to a seducing voice; and that modesty ought to defend beauty, as thorns the rose.

The order of the Golden Rose was instituted by the Pope of Rome in the twelfth century. It was formerly sent to new sovereigns at their accession, but is now presented annually to some crowned head.

A fine little poem on the rose is attributed to Sappho :—

“Did Jove a queen of flowers decree,
The rose the queen of flowers should be;
Of flowers the eye; of plants the gem;
The meadows’ blush; earth’s diadem;
Glory of colors, on the gaze
Lightening in its beauty’s blaze.
It breathes of love: it blooms the guest
Of Venus’ ever-fragrant breast:
In gaudy pomp its petals spread;
Light foliage trembles round its head;
With vermeil blossoms fresh and fair,
It laughs to the voluptuous air.”

Anacreon has sung the praises of the rose in two exquisite odes. In one he says, —

“O, lovely rose! to thee I sing,
Thou sweetest, fairest child of spring!
O, thou art dear to all the gods,
The darling of their blest abodes;
Thy breathing buds and blossoms fair
Entwine young Cupid’s golden hair,
When gayly dancing hand in hand,
He joins the Graces’ lovely band.”

The other one we give entire, sure that our readers will forgive its length for its beauty and appropriateness. The translation is by T. Bourne.

“Thou, my friend, shalt sweep the string,
I in loftiest strains will sing,
While its fragrance round us flows,
The queen of flowers, the lovely rose.
Its perfumed breath ascends the skies
On every gentle gale that sighs;
Its sweets descend to earth again,
Alike beloved by gods and men.
When spring awakes the slumbering flowers,
And music breathes amid the bowers,
Thee, darling gem, the Graces wear
Entwined amid their flowing hair;
And rosy wreaths alone may dress
The queen of love and loveliness.
In every song and fable known
The Muses claim thee as their own;
Thou bidd’st thy blooming sweetness glow
In thorny paths of pain and woe.
But O, what joy, when blest we rove
Through rosy bowers and dream of love,
While bliss on every breeze is borne,
To pluck the rose without the thorn;
With gentlest touch its leaves to press,
And raise it to our soft caress!
O, thou art still the poet’s theme,
And thee a welcome guest we deem,
To grace our feasts and deck our hair,
When Bacchus bids us banish care.
E’en Nature does thy beauties prize —
She steals thy tint to paint the skies;

For rosy-fingered is the morn
 With which the crimson veil is drawn.
 The lovely nymphs we always deck
 With rosy arms and rosy neck;
 And roseate tints are ever seen
 To bloom the cheeks of beauty's queen.
 Its power to soothe the pangs of pain
 Physicians try, nor try in vain;
 And e'en when life and hope are fled,
 Its deathless scent embalms the dead;
 For though its withering charms decay,
 And one by one all fade away,
 Its grateful smell the rose retins,
 And redolent of youth remains.
 But, lyrist, let it next be sung
 From whence this precious treasure sprung.
 When first from ocean's dewy spray
 Fair Venns rose to upper day, —
 When, fearful to the powers above,
 The arméd Pallas sprung from Jove, —
 'Twas then, they say, the jealous earth
 First gave the lovely stranger birth.
 A drop of pure nectareous dew
 From heaven the blest immortals threw;
 A while it trembled on the thorn,
 And then the lovely rose was born.
 To Bacchus they the flower assign,
 And roses still his brows entwine."

Tasso gives us an exquisite description of the rose.

"Deh mira, egli cantò, spuntar la rosa
 Dal verde suo modesta e verginella,
 Che mezzo sperta ancora e mezzo ascosa,
 Quanto si mostra men, tanto è più bella,
 Ecco poi nudo il sen già baldanzosa
 Dispiega, ecco poi langue, e non par quella,
 Quella non par, che desiata avanti
 Fu da mille donzelle e mille amanti.

"Così trapassò sì trapassar d'un giorno
 Della vita mortale il fiore e'l verde."

Ger. Lib., Canto XVI.

And Ariosto tells us, —

"La verginella è simile alla rosa
 Ch' in bel giardin su la nativa spina
 Mentre sola e sicura si riposa,
 Nè gregge nè pastor se le avvicina :

L'aura soave e l' alba rugiadosa,
 L'acqua, la terra al suo favor s'inchina;
 Gioveni vaghi e donne inamorate
 Amano averne e seni e tempie ornate."

Orl. Fur., Canto I.

The origin of the thorns on the rose is thus fancifully told:—

"Young Love, rambling through the wood,
 Found me in my solitude,
 Bright with dew, and freshly blown,
 And trembling to the zephyr's sighs.
 But as he stooped to gaze upon
 The living gem with raptured eyes,
 It chanced a bee was busy there
 Searching for its fragrant fare;
 And Cupid, stooping, too, to sip,
 The angry insect stung his lip,—
 And, gushing from the ambrosial cell,
 One bright drop on my bosom fell.
 Weeping, to his mother he
 Told the tale of treachery;
 And she, her vengeful boy to please,
 Strung his bow with captive bees;
 But placed upon my slender stem
 The poisoned sting she plucked from them;
 And none, since that eventful morn,
 Have found the flower without a thorn."

ROSEBUD. Confession of love.

"Who can view the ripened rose, nor seek
 To wear it?"

Byron.

Yet to many the rose is lovelier before she "expands her paradise of leaves."

"The rose is fairest when 'tis budding new."

Scott.

"Ah! see the virgin rose, how sweetly shee
 Doth first peepe forth with bashfull modestee,
 That fairer seemes the less ye see her may."

Spenser.

Thomson praises

"A red rosebud, moist with morning dew,
 Breathing delight."

WHITE ROSE (*Rosa alba*). Silence.

It was fabled that all roses were originally white; but the authorities differ widely as to how it became red. The legend most generally received is, that it was colored by the blood of Adonis. The ancients represented the god of Silence under the form of a young man, putting one finger on his lips, and holding in the other hand a white rose. A rose was carved on the door of banqueting halls, to signify to the guests that nothing said there should be repeated. Sometimes the rose was painted on, or suspended from, the ceiling. Hence the expression “*sub rosâ*,” for secrecy. Happy age, when a rose was enough to seal the lips of the tale-bearer!

The white rose is connected with more melancholy scenes and thoughts than the brilliant red rose. In the “*Lay of the Last Minstrel*,” when the sad, anxious Margaret came on her palfrey, —

“White was her wimple and her veil,
And her loose locks a chaplet pale
Of whitest roses bound.”

And at the tomb of Byron’s Zuleika, —

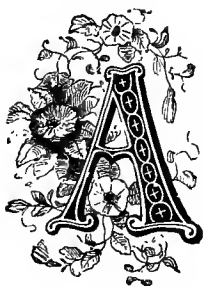
“A single rose is shedding
Its lonely lustre, meek and pale;
It looks as planted by despair, —
So white, so faint, — the slightest gale
Might whirl the leaves on high.”

“Bring flowers, pale flowers, o’er the bier to shed,
A crown for the brow of the early dead:
For this through its leaves hath the white rose burst.”

“By the garland on the hier,
Weep! a maiden claims thy tear —
Broken is the rose.”

Mrs. Hemans.

MOSS ROSE (*Rosa muscosa*). Superior merit. Voluptuousness.



PRETTY translation from the German gives us the origin of this superb rose. The Angel of the Flowers fell asleep one day under a rose tree, which gave him refreshing shade, and on waking, thus in rapture he spoke : —

“Thou queen of my bowers,
Thou fairest of flowers,
What gift shall be mine,
And what guerdon be thine?’
‘In guerdon of duty
Bestow some new beauty,’
She said; and then smiled
Like a mischievous child.
In anger he started,
But ere he departed,
To rebuke the vain flower
In the pride of her power,
He flung some rude moss
Her fair bosom across;—
But her new robes of green
So became the fair queen,
That the Angel of Flowers
Mistrusted his powers,
And was heard to declare
He had granted her prayer.”

WILD BRIER, SWEET BRIER ROSE, or EGLANTINE.
Poetry.

This is, *par excellence*, the flower of the poets. Hear them.

"A sweeter spot of earth was never found,
I looked and looked, and still with new delight,
Such joy my soul, such pleasures filled my sight.
And the fresh eglantine exhaled a breath
Whose odors were of power to raise from death."
Dryden, from Chaucer.

Spenser tells us of an arbor

"Through which the fragrant eglantine did spread
His prickling arms, entrayld with roses red,
Which daintie odours round about them threw."

"Its sides I'll plant with dew-sweet eglantine."
Keats.

"Grateful eglantine regales the smell."
Cowper

"Here eglantine embalms the air."
Scott.

"A brier rose, whose buds
Yield fragrant harvest for the honey bee."

"The chestnut flowers are past,
The crowning glories of the hawthorn fail,
But arches of sweet eglantine are cast
From every hedge."
Mrs. Hemans.

"The wild-brier rose, a fragrant cup
To hold the morning's tear."
Miss Landon.

In *Cymbeline* we find *Arviragus* saying that the grave of *Fidele*, while he lives there, shall not lack

"The leaf of eglantine, whom not to slander,
Outsweetened not thy breath."

“Eglantine est la fleur que j’aime.”

Clémence Isaure is made to say, in the pretty old romance that bears her name ; and a golden eglantine was one of the prizes at the celebrated Floral Games of Toulouse, instituted by her ; a fuller account of which will be found immediately after the article on the violet.





JULY.

MUGWORT (*Artemisia vulgaris* or *ponticum*). Good luck.
Happiness.



HERE is a superstition among the French peasantry that a wreath of this plant, gathered and worn on midsummer eve, has power to preserve the wearer from all attacks of evil spirits or men, throughout the year.

With regard to the name of this plant, a quaint old French translation of Pliny tells us, “ La gloire d'imposer les noms aux herbes n'a pas seulement appartenue aux hommes, elle est aussi venue jusqu'à enflammer le cerveau des femmes, qui ont voulu avoir leur part ; car la royne Artemisia, femme du riche Mausolus, roy de Carie, fit tant par son industrie, qu'elle baptisa de son nom l'armoise, qui, auparavant, étoit appelée *parthenis*.

Toutefois il y en a qui tiennent ce nom *d'artemisia* avoir été imposé à l'armoise, à raison de la déesse Artemis Ilithya (*Diana*), parceque cette herbe est particulièrement bonne aux femmes." The fragrant southern-wood belongs to this family, and also the bitter wormwood.

WHITE JASMINE (*Jasminum officinale*). Amiability.

The jasmine seems to have been created as the emblem of amiability. Its supple branches bend gracefully to every caprice of the trainer; and whether in the shape of bush, tree, or arbor, it lavishes on us a shower of fragrant, star-like blossoms. It grows now in all warm climates, but was introduced into Europe from India by Spanish navigators, about 1560. Its fragrance, like the woodbine's, is stronger towards night.

" Many a perfume breathed
From plants that wake while others sleep,
From timid jasmine buds, that keep
Their odors to themselves all day,
But, when the sunlight dies away,
Let the delicious secret out."

Moore.

The Earl of Carlisle is the author of the following pretty stanzas: —

TO A JASMINE TREE.

" My slight and slender jasmine tree,
That bloomest on my border tower,
Thou art more dearly loved by me
Than all the wreaths of fairy bower:
I ask not, while I near thee dwell,
Arabia's spice, or Syria's rose;
Thy light festoons more freshly smell,
Thy virgin white more freshly glows.

My mild and winsome jasmine tree,
That climbest up the dark gray wall,
Thy tiny flowerets seem in glee,
Like silver spray-drops, down to fall :
Say, did they from their leaves thus peep
When mailed moss-troopers rode the hill,
When helméd warders paced the keep,
And bugles blew for Belted Will ?

My free and feathery jasmine tree,
Within the fragrance of thy breath
Yon dungeon grated to its key,
And the chained captive pined for death.
On border fray, on feudal crime,
I dream not, while I gaze on thee;
The chieftains of that stern old time
Could ne'er have loved a jasmine tree."

It is related that a duke of Tuscany, who was the first possessor of the plant in Italy, forbade his gardener to take off a single flower or cutting. The gardener might have been faithful had he not been in love. On the birthday of his mistress he presented her a bouquet containing one sprig of the precious jasmine. She put it in moist earth to keep fresh : it took root, grew, and multiplied under her skilful hands. She was poor, her lover was not rich, and her careful mother forbade their union. But the young girl, by selling her jasmines, soon amassed a little dowry. The Tuscan girls still wear a wreath of jasmine on their wedding day ; and they have a proverb that a maiden worthy to wear this wreath is rich enough to make her husband's fortune.

CARNATION (*Dianthus caryophyllus*). Pure and deep love.

The variety of shades produced in this flower by skilful cultivation is almost infinite, making it a great

favorite with florists. But through all changes it still preserves its beauty and fragrance. The great Condé loved and cultivated carnations, and had the courage to wear one in his button-hole before Louis XIV., whose aversion to perfumes is well known.

Pope says, —

“To the Elysian shades
Dismiss my soul, where no carnation fades.”

And in one of the most enchanting scenes that even Shakspeare ever wrote, he makes sweet Perdita say, —

“The fairest flowers of the season
Are our carnations and streaked gillyflowers.”

VERVAIN (*Verbena hastata*). Enchantment.

Vervain was used among the ancients in various kinds of divination, and among other properties, that of reconciling enemies was attributed to it. When the Romans sent heralds to carry to nations peace or war, one of them carried vervain. The Druids had the greatest veneration for this plant; before gathering it they made a sacrifice to the Earth. The Magi, when adoring the sun, held branches of vervain in their hands. Venus *victrix* wore a crown of myrtle interwoven with vervain, and the Germans to this day give a wreath of vervain to brides, as if to put them under the protection of this goddess. In the northern provinces of France, the shepherds gather it with ceremonies and words known only to themselves.

TARES (*Lolium temulentum*). Vice.

The tare is made to symbolize vice. Its stalk resembles that of wheat; it grows up in the finest harvests. The hand of the wise and skilful cultivator roots it up with care, that it may not be confounded with the good grain. Thus a wise instructor ought diligently to eradicate every inclination to vice which springs up in the youthful heart; but he should beware lest he uproot at the same time the germs of virtue.

MARSHMALLOW (*Althea officinalis*). Beneficence.

The marshmallow, which typifies beneficence, is the poor man's friend. It grows wild along the brook and around the cottage, and sometimes shows its modest head in the garden. It is a soft, silvery-looking plant, with delicate, pretty pink flowers. The flowers, the leaves, the stalk, and the root are all useful. Various pastes and sirups are prepared from its juices, as pleasant to the taste as they are excellent for the health. A lost traveller has sometimes found wholesome nutriment in its root. We need only look around us to discover, everywhere in nature, proofs of love and foresight. But this tender mother often conceals, in plants as in men, the greatest virtues under the most modest exterior.

FLOS ADONIS (*Adonis autumnalis*). Painful recollections.

Adonis was killed by a wild boar. Venus, who had left for him the delights of Cythera, shed tears over his fate: they were not lost; the earth received them, and immediately produced a slender plant covered with flowers like drops of blood.

LOCUST (*Robinia pseudo-acacia*). Platonic love.

This fine tree was carried from America to France, more than a century ago, by the botanist Robin, who gave it his name. Its foliage is exceedingly light and fresh, and its white, drooping flowers very fragrant. The Indians are said to have made bows of its wood, and buried their dead under its shade.



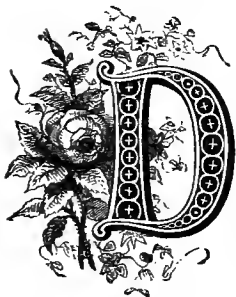


AUGUST.

WHITE LILY (*Lilium candidum*). Majesty. Purity.

“Il est le roi des fleurs, dont la rose est la reine.”

Boisjolin.



DEAR to the heart of every one is this regal flower. It stands with ineffable grace on the elegant stem which rises from its circle of long green leaves, and breathes out the richest incense. It is a native of Syria, but has reigned

in our gardens from time immemorial. The sovereigns of France have especially honored it. It bloomed in the gardens of Charlemagne. Louis VII. placed it on his coat of arms, coins, and seals. Philip Augustus

sprinkled his standard with lilies. St. Louis wore a ring representing, in enamel and relief, a wreath of lilies and daisies, and on the stone was graven a crucifix with these words: "Hors cet anel pourrions-nous trouver amour?" because, indeed, this ring combined for the pious king the emblems of all he held dear—his religion, his country, and his wife.

"Crowned with a wreath of lilies, breathing cool
Their fragrance o'er his throbbing temples, comes
July, with languid step."

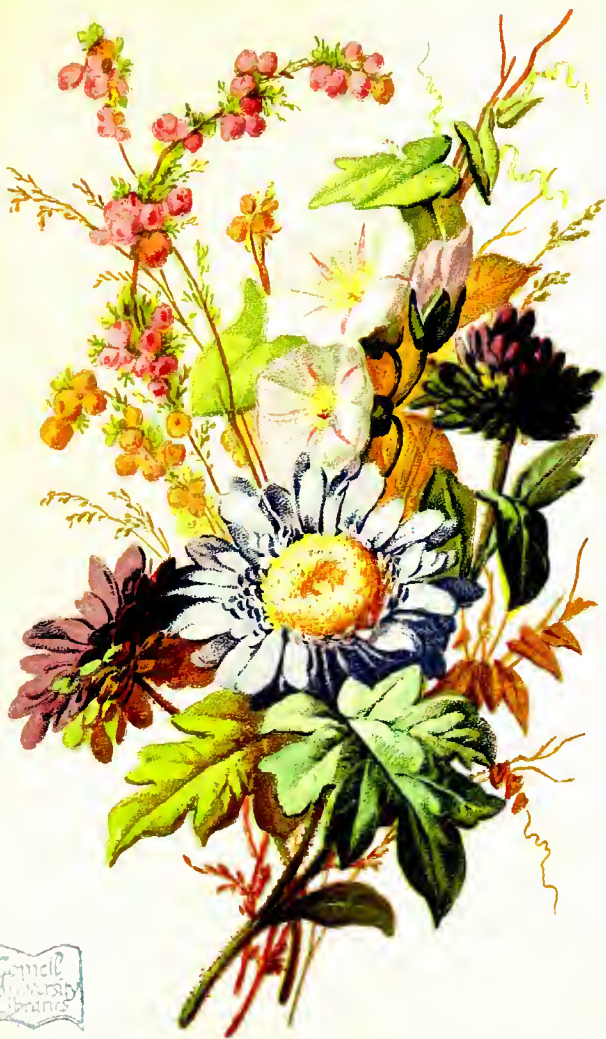
"Long alleys, falling down to twilight grotts,
Or opening upon level plots
Of crowned lilies, standing near
Purple-spikéd lavender." *Tennyson.*

"Nor snow-white lily, called so proudly fair,
Though by the poor man's cot she loves to dwell,
Nor finds his little garden scant of room
To bid her stately buds in beauty bloom."
Mrs. Norton.

GARDEN GILLYFLOWER (*Cheiranthus annuus*).

Lasting Beauty.

The gillyflower, less graceful than the rose, less majestic than the lily, keeps its freshness longer than either. The old English poets loved the gillyflower, and made frequent allusions to it. In Germany, surprisingly fine effects are produced with this flower. Mme. de la Tour says, "At an old chateau near Luxemburg were arranged, along an immense terrace, four rows of vases, of coarse ware, but well shaped, and of the purest white; these were all filled with the finest red



W. H. H.
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gillyflowers. Towards sunset one would have said that living flames were issuing from these vases, and a balsamic odor filled the air around."

WHEAT (*Triticum vulgare*). Wealth.

This plant seems to have been conferred on man, together with the use of fire, to assure to him the sceptre of the earth. It is one of the first links of society, because its culture exacts mutual labor and services. An Arab, lost in the desert, had eaten nothing for two days. Nearly dead with hunger, in passing by a well where caravans stopped, he saw on the sand a little leather bag. "God be praised," said he, picking it up; "I believe this is a little flour." He hastily opened it, but, seeing what it contained, exclaimed, "Unfortunate that I am! It is nothing but gold dust!"

DAHLIA (*Dahlia*). My gratitude exceeds your cares. Novelty.

This showy plant comes from Mexico, where its roots are eaten, roasted in the ashes. It was first introduced into Europe as an edible, but proved of too strong a flavor, and botanists soon began to cultivate it for its flowers, which were at first only single. It is named from Andrew Dahl, a celebrated Swedish botanist. Cultivation has developed a countless variety of shades, while improving the shape of this flower, and English gardeners hold it in great esteem.

GARDEN MARIGOLD (*Calendula officinalis*). Grief. Chagrin.

"No marygolds yet closéd are,
No shadows yet appear."

Herrick.

"But, maiden, see, the day is waxen olde,
'And 'gins to shut in with the marygold."

Browne.

The celebrated Mme. Lebrun painted a pretty little picture, representing Grief under the form of a young man, pale and languishing, whose head seemed bent under the weight of a wreath of marigolds. It blooms nearly all the year round; therefore the Romans called it the Flower of the Calends. It is open only from nine A. M. till about three P. M., but turns towards the sun, and follows his course from east to west. In July and August it emits luminous sparks by night, like the nasturtium and a few other plants of the same color. Margaret of Orleans, the maternal grandmother of Henry IV., took for her device a marigold turning to the sun, with the motto, "*Je ne veux suivre que lui seul.*"

The older poets called it simply *gold*. Chaucer devotes the marigold to jealousy.

"and jalousie,
'That weved of yelwe goldes a girlonde."

Spenser associates it both with bridals and funerals. Chatterton mentions

"The mary-hudde, that shutteth with the light."

Shakspeare evidently cherished this flower.

“The marigold, that goes to bed with the sun,
And with him rises weeping.”

“like marigolds, had sheathed their light,
And canopied in darkness sweetly lay,
Till they might open to adorn the day.”

“Hark! hark! the lark at Heaven’s gate sings,
And Phœbus ’gins arise,
His steeds to water at those springs
On chaliced flowers that lies.
And winking mary-budds begin
To ope their golden eyes;
With every thing that pretty bin,
My lady sweet, arise,
Arise, arise!”

The practical Gay tells us, —

“Fair is the marigold, for pottage meet.”

The more poetical Keats sings, —

“Open afresh your round of starry folds,
Ye ardent marigolds!
Dry up the moisture of your golden lids;
For great Apollo bids
That in these days your praises shall be sung
On many harps, which he has lately strung;
And when again your dewiness he kisses,
Tell him I have you in my world of blisses:
So haply when I rove in some far vale,
His mighty voice may come upon the gale.”

We end with part of a fine piece by George Wither

“When with a serious musing I behold
The grateful and obsequious marigold,
How duly every morning she displays
Her open breast, when Titan spreads his rays;
How she observes him in his daily walk,
Still bending towards him her small, slender stalk;
How, when he down declines, she droops and mourns,
Bedewed as ’twere with tears till he returns;

And how she veils her flowers when he is gone,
 As if she scornéd to be lookéd on
 By an inferior eye, or did condemn
 To wait upon a meaner light than him ;—
 When I thus meditate, methinks the flowers
 Have spirits far more generous than ours,
 And give us fair example to despise
 The servile fawnings and idolatries
 Wherewith we court these earthly things below,
 Which merit not the service we bestow."

MIGNONETTE (*Reseda odorata*). Your qualities surpass your charms.

" No gorgeous flowers the meek Reseda grace,
 Yet sip with esger trunk yon busy race
 Her simple cup, nor heed the dazzling gem
 That beams in Fritillaria's diadem."

Evans.

Cowper says in the Task, —

" What are the casements lined with creeping herbs,
 The prouder sashes fronted with a range
 Of orange, myrtle, or the fragrant weed,
 The Frenchman's darling ! "

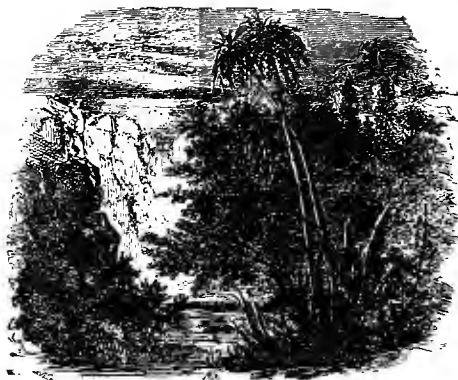
We owe the reseda to Egypt. Linnæus compared its perfume to that of ambrosia. At sunrise and sunset it is sweetest and most penetrating. Flowering from spring till autumn, in doors or out, it is a universal favorite. By keeping it in a temperate, even atmosphere, it grows woody, and becomes a little tree, living several years.

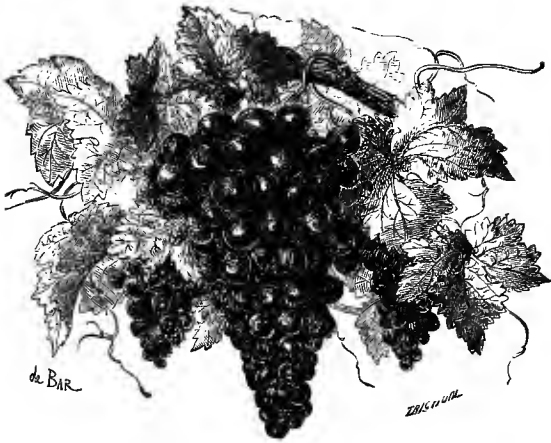
DATURA (*Datura arborea*). Deceitful charms.

The foliage of this plant seems faded and languishing in the daytime, but at night appears reanimated, and its beautiful flowers exhale an intoxicating

but dangerous perfume. One of Hoffman's wonderful stories was suggested by it; and Mrs. Hemans wrote the following sonnet upon it:—

“Majestic plant! such fairy dreams as he
Nursed where the bee sucks in the cowslip's bell,
Are not thy train: those flowers of vase-like swell,
Clear, large, with dewy moonlight filled from high,
And in their monumental purity
Serenely drooping, round thee seem to draw
Visions linked strangely with that silent awe
Which broods o'er Sculpture's works. A meet ally
For those heroic forms, the simply grand,
Art thou; and worthy, carved by plastic hand,
Above some kingly poet's tomb to shine
In spotless marble; honoring one whose train
Soared, upon wings of thought that knew no stain,
Free through the starry heavens of truth divine.”





A U T U M N .

S E P T E M B E R .

FORGET-ME-NOT (*Myosotis palustris*). Forget me not.



HERE is a flower, a lovely flower,
 Tinged deep with Faith's unchanging
 hue,
 Pure as the ether in its hour
 Of loveliest and serenest blue.
 The streamlet's gentle side it seeks,
 The silent fount, the shaded grot,
 And sweetly to the heart it speaks,
 Forget me not, forget me not!

Halleck. (Trans. from the German.)

A story is told in Germany, that two young lovers
 were walking on the banks of the Danube, when a

cluster of flowers of celestial blue floated by on the stream. Struck by their beauty, the girl admires and regrets them. Her lover springs into the water, seizes the flowers, and has just time to throw them at her feet, crying, "Love, forget me not," before he disappears in the swift current.

CHINA-ASTER (*Aster sinensis*). Variety.

This beautiful aster comes from China, where it is cultivated in great perfection, and extensively used as a decoration. They are planted in pots, and arranged according to their colors in charming lines and masses, the effect of which is often heightened by their reflection in a stream or sheet of water. The china-aster owes its variety to skilful culture. Thus study can vary continually the graces of the mind.

TUBEROSE (*Polianthes tuberosa*). Voluptuousness.

The tuberose seems to be first mentioned by a European writer in 1594. There has been some doubt whether it came from the East Indies or from Mexico; but the latter country seems to have most evidence in its favor. Father Camell says it was imported from Mexico to the Philippine Islands by the Spaniards, who called it *Vara de S. José*, or St. Joseph's wand.

It was carried from Persia to France in 1632. It was single then, but its petals were doubled under the hands of a skilful florist of Leyden named Lecour;

thence it spread all over the world. In Russia it blooms only for czars and courtiers, but in Peru it is naturalized. Its lovely spires terminate a tall, slender stem, and exhale a strong, sweet perfume, which is oppressive if inhaled too closely.

Moore tells us of

"The tuberose with her silvery light,
That in the gardens of Malay
Is called the 'mistress of the night,'
So like a bride scented and bright,
She comes out when the sun's away."

MORNING GLORY (*Convolvulus purpureus*). Coquetry.

"Convolvulus, in streakéd vases flush."

Keats.

"Yes, thou canst smile and be as gay
As though no heart thy guile had broken,
While every step along my way
Brings up of thee some painful token.

Thou breathest in a dozen ears
The same fond words once breathed to me;
While I, alas! in secret tears,
Can only think and dream of thee."

The Flower Vase.

"Aux feux dont l'air étincelle

S'ouvre la belle-de-jour;

Zéphyr la flatte de l'aile:

La friponne encore appelle

Les papillons d'alentour.

Coquettes, c'est votre emblème:

Le grand jour, le bruit vous plaît.

Briller est votre art suprême;

Sans éclat, le plaisir même

Devient pour vous sans attrait."

Ph. de la Madeleine.

HELIOTROPE (*Heliotropium peruvianum*). I adore you. Intoxication.

"Heliotrope, whose gray and heavy wreath
Mimics the orchard blossom's fruity breath."

Mrs. Norton.

One day, the celebrated Jussieu, botanizing in the Cordilleras, felt himself almost intoxicated with a most delicious perfume: he expected to discover some brilliant flower, but found only pretty bushes of a soft green, crowned with clusters of a pale, lustreless purple. He approached these bushes (which were six feet high), and saw that the flowers with which they were loaded, all turned to the sun. Struck with this circumstance, he gave it the name of heliotrope, from the Greek words *helios*, sun, and *trope*, turn. Elated with his new conquest, he hastened to gather some seeds of it, and send to the *Jardin du Roi*. The ladies of Paris received the new plant with enthusiasm; they placed it in the most precious vases, called it "herb of love," and received with indifference a bouquet which did not contain it. It was cultivated for the first time, in Europe, in 1740, and immediately took its place as a favorite in fashionable society.

SUNFLOWER (*Helianthus annuus*). False riches.

"The gaudy orient sunflower from the crowd
Uplifts its golden circle."

Maturin.

"Sunflowers, planted for their gilded show,
That scale the window's lattice ere they blow;
Then, sweet to habitants within the sheds,
Peep through the diamond panes their golden heads."

Clare.

"Uplift, proud sunflower, to thy favorite orb,
That disk whereon his brightness seems to dwell;
And as thou seem'st his radiance to absorb,
Proclaim thyself the garden's sentinel."

Barton.

The sunflower, too, is a native of Peru, where it was formerly honored as the image of the star of day. The Virgins of the Sun, in their religious festivals, wore a golden crown, representing this immense flower, which also glittered on their breasts and in their hands. Poets have wrongly imagined this plant to turn towards the sun, and sometimes confounded it with the heliotrope, though so unlike it.

Lord Thurlow crowns Jealousy with the sunflower, — yellow being her appropriate color.

It is said that Pythius, a rich Lydian, possessing several gold mines, neglected the culture of his estates, and only employed his numerous slaves in the mines. His wise wife one day ordered a supper to be served up to him, at which all the dishes were filled with gold. "I give you," said she, "the only thing we have in abundance; you can reap only what you sow; see yourself whether gold is so great a good!" This lesson made the desired impression, and he acknowledged that Providence had not abandoned true riches to man's avarice.

WALL-FLOWER (*Cheiranthus cheiri*). Fidelity in misfortune.

"The yellow wall-flower stained with iron brown."

Thomson.

"With cloudy fire the wall-flowers burned."

"Wall-flowers in fragrance burn themselves away
With the sweet season on her precious pyre."

Massey.

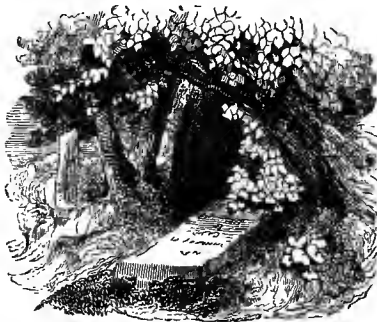
“ Flower of the solitary place !
 Gray Ruin’s golden crown,
 That lendest melancholy grace
 To haunts of old renown.”

Moir.

“ An emblem true thou art
 Of love’s enduring lustre, given
 To cheer a lonely heart.”

Barton.

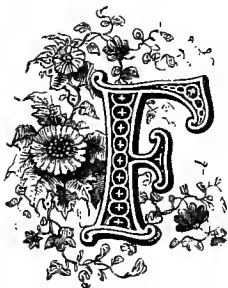
Minstrels and troubadours formerly wore a sprig of wall-flower as the emblem of an affection which resists time and survives misfortune. During the reign of terror in France, the sepulchres of the kings in the Abbey of St. Denis were broken open and violated, and the remains thrown into an obscure court behind the choir of the church. There the revolution forgot them. The poet Treneuil, going to visit this sad spot, found it brilliant with the blossoms of the wall-flower. This plant, true to its character, breathed out its perfume, like incense rising to heaven, and inspired the poet with a fine apostrophe to it.





OCTOBER.

IVY (*Hedera helix*). Friendship.



RIENDSHIP has chosen for its device an ivy surrounding a fallen tree, with the motto, "Nothing can detach me." In Greece the hymeneal altar was wreathed with ivy, and a branch of it was presented to the bridal pair, as the symbol of indissoluble union. The Bacchantes, old Silenus, and Bacchus himself, were crowned with ivy. In Egypt it was consecrated to Osiris. The fadeless green of the ivy made it a suitable crown for the poet.

"An ivy wreath, the poet's prize,
Would lift Mæcenas to the skies."

Horace.

It was a favorite with Milton. Eve bids Adam

“Direct the clasping ivy where to climb.”

Wordsworth, speaking of an old church, overgrown with ivy, gives us this pretty picture : —

“Dying insensibly away
From human thoughts and purposes,
The building seems, wall, roof, and tower,
To how to some transforming power,
And blend with the surrounding trees.”

“Hast thou seen, in winter’s stormiest day,
The trunk of a blighted oak;
Not dead, but sinking in slow decay,
Beneath Time’s resistless stroke;
Round which a luxuriant ivy had grown,
And wrenth it with verdure no longer its own?”

O, smile not, nor think it a worthless thing,
If it be with instruction fraught—
That which will closest and longest cling
Is alone worth a serious thought.
Should aught be unlovely which thus can shed
Grace on the dying, and leaves not the dead?”

Barton.

With the Ivy Song of Mrs. Hemans, we end.

“O, how could fancy crown with thee,
In ancient days, the God of Wine,
And bid thee at the banquet be
Companion of the vine?
Ivy! thy home is where each sound
Of revelry hath long been o’er,
Where song and beaker once went round,
But now are known no more.
Where long fallen gods recline,
There the place is thine.

The Roman on his battle plains,
Where kings before his eagles bent,
With thee, amidst exulting strains,
Shadowed the victor’s tent.

Though shining there in deathless green,
 Triumphally thy boughs might wave,
 Better thou lov'st the silent scene
 Around the victor's grave :
 Urn and sculpture half divine
 Yield their place to thine.

The cold halls of the regal dead,
 Where lone the Italian sunbeams dwell,
 Where hollow sounds the lightest tread —
 Ivy ! they know thee well !
 And far above the festal vine
 Thou wav'st where once proud banners hung,
 Where mouldering turrets crest the Rhine,
 The Rhine, still fresh and young !
 Tower and rampart o'er the Rhine,
 Ivy ! all are thine !

High from the fields of air look down
 Those eyries of a vanished race,
 Where harp, and battle, and renown
 Have passed and left no trace.
 But thou art there ! serenely bright,
 Meeting the mountain storms with bloom,
 Thou that wilt climb the loftiest height,
 Or crown the lowliest tomb.
 Ivy, Ivy ! all are thine —
 Palace, hearth, and shrine !

'Tis still the same ; our pilgrim tread
 O'er classic plains, through deserts free,
 On the mute path of ages fled,
 Still meets decay and thee.
 And still let man his fabrics rear,
 August in beauty, stern in power, —
 Days pass — thou 'Ivy never sere ;'
 And thou shalt have thy dower.
 All are thine, or must be thine —
 Temple, pillar, shrine ! ”

MEADOW SAFFRON (*Colchicum autumnalis*). My best days
 are past.

The ancients believed that this plant, from the fields
 of Colchis, owed its origin to some drops of the magic

liquor which Medea prepared to make old Æson young. This caused it to be regarded as a preservative against all sorts of maladies. It is still used in gout and rheumatism. The seed does not ripen until the following spring. The melancholy nymph weaves herself a crown of its pale violet flowers, and consecrates it to the happy days which have fled to return no more.

FOUR O'CLOCK, or MARVEL OF PERU (*Mirabilis jalapa*). Timidity.

This plant, known also as jalap, princess's leaf, and belle-de-nuit, is a native of the Malay Isles, and in its own climate is an elegant shrub. It opens its timid bells at four in the afternoon, closing them again at four in the morning.

We cannot refrain from transcribing here the following graceful lines of Constant Dubos : —

“ Solitaire smante des nuits,
 Pourquoi ces timides alarmes,
 Quand ma muse au jour que tu fuis
 S'apprête à révéler tes charmes ?
 Si, par pudeur, aux indiscrets
 Tu caches ta fleur purpurine,
 En nous dérochant tes attraits,
 Permets encore qu'on les devine.

Lorsque l'aube vient réveiller
 Les brillantes filles de Flore, —
 Seule tu sembles sommeiller,
 Et craindre l'éclat de l'aurore.
 Quand l'ombre efface leurs couleurs,
 Tu reprends alors ta parure,
 Et de l'absence de tes sœurs,
 Tu viens consoler la nature.

Sous le voile mystérieux
 De la craïotive modestie
 Tu veux échapper à nos yeux,
 Et tu n'en es que plus jolie;
 On cherche, on aime à découvrir,
 Le doux plaisir que tu recèles;
 Ah ! pour encore les embellir,
 Donne ton secret à nos belles."

FRAGRANT COLTSFOOT (*Tussilago fragrans*). Justice shall be done you.

Genius, concealed under a modest exterior, does not strike the vulgar. But if the eye of a discriminating judge meets it, immediately it obtains the acclamations of those whose stupid indifference could not comprehend it. Plants have the same fate as men, and often require a patron to be appreciated. The fragrant coltsfoot, in spite of its sweet odor, lived a long time unknown at the foot of Mount Pila, where it would doubtless flourish ignored to this day, if a learned botanist, M. Villau, of Grenoble, had not appreciated its merits, and given it a prominent place in his works. It is very welcome in the drawing-room, as it comes at a season when other flowers are scarce.

SCARLET GERANIUM (*Pelargonium inquinans*). Silliness.

Mme. de Staël was always angry when a man of no intellect was introduced into her circle. One day, however, a friend risked presenting a young Swiss officer, of most amiable appearance. Deceived by appearances, the lady grew animated, and said a thousand flattering

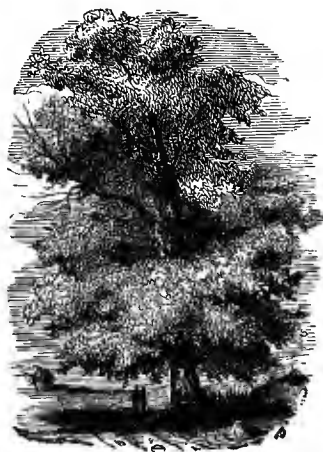
things to the new-comer, who seemed at first mute with surprise and admiration. At last, after he had listened nearly an hour without opening his mouth, she began to mistrust his silence, and asked him some questions so direct that he was forced to reply. But, alas ! he gave only the silliest answers. Mme. de Stael, angry at having thrown away her trouble and her wit, turned to her friend and said, " Truly, sir, you resemble my gardener, who thought to please me this morning by bringing me a pot of scarlet geranium ; but I sent him away, begging him never to let me see it again." " Why so ? " asked the young man, confounded. " Because, sir, since you wish to know, this geranium is finely dressed in red ; so long as you only look at it, it is pleasing ; but the moment you press it slightly, it gives out only a disagreeable odor." Saying these words, she rose and went out, leaving the young man with cheeks as red as his coat, or the flower to which he had been compared.

CYPRESS (*Cupressus*). Mourning.

- " Peace to the dust that in silence reposes
Beneath the dark shades of the cypress and yew."
Pierpont.
- " And the wild cypress wave in tender gloom."
Byron.
- " The nodding cypress formed a fragrant shade."
Pope.
- " In cypress chests my arras counterpanes."
Shakspeare.

The cypress is a tall, straight, evergreen tree, of a fragrant smell — the leaves bitter. Its wood is almost imperishable. The Romans devoted it to funereal uses, and the Orientals plant it in their cemeteries. Spenser tells us that in the garden of Proserpina —

“There mournfull cypresse grew in greatest store.”





NOVEMBER.

OAK (*Quercus*). Hospitality.

“The builder oake, sole king of forrests all.”

Spenser.



THE ancients believed that the oak, born with the earth, gave shelter and sustenance to the first men. This tree, consecrated to Jupiter, shaded his cradle in Arcadia. The civic crown of oak leaves appeared to the Romans the most desirable of rewards. In Epirus, the oaks of Dodona gave oracles; those of Gaul covered the mysteries of the Druids. An account of all the celebrated oak trees in history would fill a volume. Tennyson has sung the “Talking Oak,” and

Millevoye "La feuille de chêne." Bryant eloquently wrote, —

"This mighty oak —
By whose immovable stem I stand, and seem
Almost annihilated — not a prince
In all the proud old world beyond the deep
Ere wore his crown as loftily as he
Wears the green coronal of leaves with which
Thy hand has graced him."

AMARANTH (*Amaranthus*). Immortality.

"Sad Amaranthus, made a flowre but late,
Sad Amaranthus, in whose purple gore
Me seemes I see Aminta's wretched fate,
To whom sweet poets' verse hath given endlesse date."

The amaranth is one of the last gifts of Autumn. The ancients associated it with supreme honors, and adorned with it the foreheads of the gods. In the "Jeux Floraux," at Toulouse, the prize for the best lyric was a golden amaranth. It has, for some reason or other, been a favorite of the poets; and Milton, in Book III. of his great poem, pays it this homage: —

"To the ground,
With solemn adoration, down they cast
Their crowns, inwove with amaranth and gold,
Immortal amaranth, a flower which once
In Paradise, fast by the tree of life,
Began to bloom; but soon, for man's offence,
To Heaven removed, where first it grew, there grows
And flowers aloft, shading the fount of life.
And where the river of bliss, through midst of Heaven,
Rolls o'er Elysian flowers her amber stream,
With these, that never fade, the spirits elect
Bind their resplendent locks inwreathed with beams."

And again in Lycidas, —

"Bid Amaranthus all his beauty shed."



1891

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There are many species of amaranth. That which is called coxcomb (a corruption of *cock's comb*) is very handsome, and is said to grow to a great size in Japan. Another variety is popularly called Love-lies-bleeding. In Campbell's poem of "O'Connor's Child," he makes the heroine say, —

"This purple flower my tears have nursed
 A hero's blood supplied its bloom :
 I love it, for it was the first
 That grew on Connocht Moran's tomb,"

* * * *

"Nor would I change my buried love
 For any heart of living mould.
 No, for I am a hero's child —
 I'll hunt my quarry on the wild,
 And still my home this mansion make,
 Of all unheeded and unheeding,
 And cherish, for my warrior's sake,
 The flower of love-lies-bleeding."

PARSLEY (*Apium petroselinum*). Festivity.

Parsley was in great repute among the Greeks. At banquets they crowned themselves with it, to excite gayety and appetite. In the Nemean games the victor received for prize a wreath of parsley. It was supposed to be a native of Sardinia, because on old medals that province was represented by a woman at whose side is a vase of parsley; but it is found in cool, shady places throughout the south of Europe. The beautiful verdure of this plant heightens the elegance of the dishes it adorns.

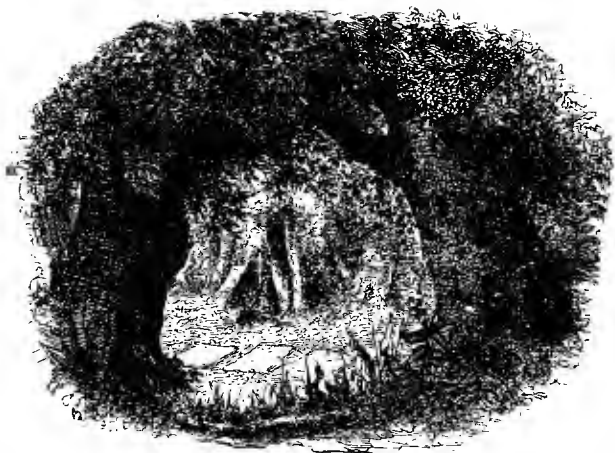
CORNELIAN CHERRY (*Cornus mascula*). Continuance.

This tree rises only to the height of eighteen or twenty feet, but is slow of growth, and lives for centuries. It blossoms in Spring, and in Autumn produces its brilliant red fruit. The Greeks consecrated it to Apollo, doubtless because this god presided over intellectual labors, which demand much time and reflection. This tree is the emblem of patience to all those who would win the laurel crown for poetry or eloquence.

A HEAP OF FLOWERS. We will die together.

A pile of flowers and fruit decomposes the air, and renders it unfit for respiration. This sad property inspired the German poet Freiligrath to write a striking little piece called "The Vengeance of the Flowers."





WINTER.

DECEMBER.

SERVICE TREE (*Pyrus domestica*). Prudence.



ACH plant and tree has a character of its own. The giddy almond hastens to give her flowers to the Spring at the risk of having no fruit for the Autumn, while the service tree, which grows slowly, only bears fruit when it has

attained its full strength; but then the harvest is certain. This is why it is called the type of prudence. Handsome and durable, it keeps its bright red berries all winter—a food provided in the midst of the snow for the little birds.

MISTLETOE (*Viscum verticillatum*). I surmount everything.

The following legend has come down to us from the days of the Druids. The god Balder having dreamed that he should die, his mother, Frigga, conjured fire, metals, maladies, water, animals, serpents, and plants, not to harm her son, and her conjurations were of such power that nothing could resist. Loke, the enemy of Balder, wished to know the cause of his invulnerability, and disguising himself under the form of an old woman, went to ask Frigga. He learned that everything in nature was sworn not to hurt Balder, except one little plant, which seemed too insignificant to harm, having not even a root of its own. It was the mistletoe. Loke immediately ran to find some, and, coming where the gods were fighting against the invulnerable Balder, asks the blind Heder, “Why dost not thou, too, throw arrows at Balder?” “I am blind,” replied Heder, “and have no arms.” Loke presented the mistletoe to him, and said, “Balder is before thee.” It is thrown, and Balder falls lifeless. Thus the invulnerable son of a goddess is slain by a branch of mistletoe thrown by a blind enemy.

The mistletoe is a little evergreen shrub, growing on the tops of the tallest trees; even the proud oak becomes its slave, and feeds it with his own substance. It was regarded as peculiarly sacred by the Druids. Every one is familiar with the English customs connected with it as a Christmas decoration.

“Bright-headed as the merry May dawn
She floated down the dance;
I thought some angel must have gone
Our human way by chance.
I held my hands and caught my bliss:
Children, I’ll show you how!
And earth touched heaven in a kiss
Under the mistletoe bough.”

Massey.

MOSS (*Cryptogamia*). Maternal love.

Like those friends repulsed neither by misfortune nor ingratitude, the mosses, banished from cultivated fields, advance towards dry, uncultivated lands, to cover them with their own substance, which is by degrees changed into fertile soil. They extend over marshes, and soon transform them into useful meadows. They form, in the forest shade, a turfy carpet, where the shepherd, the lover, and the poet love to repose. Without these plants, so little regarded by us, a part of the globe would be uninhabitable. In Lapland, the families cover with moss the subterranean huts, where they brave the longest winters. Their numerous herds of reindeer know no other food, yet they supply their masters with delicious milk, eatable flesh, and warm furs.

LAURESTINE (*Viburnum tinus*). I die if neglected.

This pretty shrub, improperly called *laurustinus*, comes to us from Spain, and is brilliant with verdure and flowers when other plants are stripped of them. It always requires assiduous attention, which, however, it well repays.





JANUARY.

LAUREL (*Laurus nobilis*). Glory.

“Yield me one leaf of Daphne’s deathless plant.”

Byron.



HE laurel or bay tree has been the symbol of glory and victory in every age and among every people. The lovely Daphne, daughter of the river Peneus, was loved by Apollo; but she fled from his proffered caresses. He pursued her, and as he began to gain on her, she invoked her father’s aid, and was changed into the laurel. Apollo crowned his head with the leaves, and ordered that it should be esteemed sacred to him. It grows in great profusion on the banks of the Peneus, and its aromatic

evergreen branches rise there to the height of the tallest trees. The property of resisting lightning was anciently ascribed to it.

The *Flora Domestica* says, "The bay or laurel was in great esteem with physicians. The statue of *Æsculapius*, in allusion, perhaps, to his father, *Apollo*, was adorned with its leaves. From the custom which prevailed in some places of crowning the young doctors in physic with this laurel in berry, the students were called *baccalaureats*, or bachelors."

Every poet has sung the laurel. *Byron* said of *Petrarch*, —

"Watering the tree which bore his lady's name
With his melodious tears, he gave himself to fame."

Though the laurel be the "meede of mighty conquerors," *Oglevie* bids us remember that

"Short is Ambition's gay, deceitful dream;
Though wreaths of blooming laurel bind her brow,
Calm thought dispels the visionary scheme,
And Time's cold breath dissolves the withering bough."

This classic tree is not a native of our country; but we have the beautiful *kalmia*, or American sheep laurel, which can challenge comparison with any shrub of Europe.

HOLLY (*Ilex*). Forethought.

"Boldest of plants that ever faced the wind."

Wordsworth.

The holly brings to mind delightful scenes of Christmas festivities and family joys. Its curiously cut,

shining leaves, and rich clusters of scarlet berries, make it an unequalled ornament for church, palace, or cottage. Among the best lines Southey ever wrote are the following:—

THE HOLLY TREE.

“O reader, hast thou ever stood to see
 The holly tree:
 The eye that contemplates it well perceives
 Its glossy leaves
 Ordered by an intelligence so wise,
 As might confound the atheist's sophistries.

Below, a circling fence, its leaves are seen
 Wrinkled and keen;
 No grazing cattle through their prickly round
 Can reach to wound;
 But as they grow where nothing is to fear,
 Smooth and unarmed the pointless leaves appear.

I love to view these things with curious eyes,
 And moralize;
 And in this wisdom of the holly tree
 Can emblems see
 Wherewith perchance to make a pleasant rhyme—
 One which may profit in the after-time.

Thus, though abroad perchance I might appear
 Harsh and austere,
 To those who on my leisure would intrude
 Reserved and rude,—
 Gentle at home amid my friends I'd be,
 Like the high leaves upon the holly tree.

And should my youth, as youth is apt, I know,
 Some harshness show,—
 All vain asperities I day by day
 Would wear away,
 Till the smooth temper of my age should be
 Like the high leaves upon the holly tree.

And, as when all the summer trees are seen
So bright and green,
The holly leaves their fadeless hues display —
Less bright than they;
But when the bare and wintry woods we see,
What then so cheerful as the holly tree?

So serious should my youth appear among
The thoughtless throng,
So would I seem amid the young and gay
More grave than they,
That in my age as cheerful I might be
As the green winter of the holly tree."

ALOE (*Aloe*). Grief. Bitterness.

The aloe holds to the soil only by weak roots; it loves to grow in the desert; its taste is very bitter. Thus grief withdraws us from the world, detaches us from the earth, and fills our hearts with bitterness. These plants live almost entirely on air, and affect grotesque and wonderful forms. Mexico and the sands of Africa are their native climes.

AGNUS CASTUS. Coldness. Life without love.

Dioscorides, Pliny, and Galienus inform us that the priestesses of Ceres formed their virginal couch of the fragrant branches of this shrub, which covers itself with long tufts of white or violet flowers, and that they regarded it as the palladium of their chastity. Nuns used to drink a water distilled from it, to banish terrestrial thoughts from their solitary cells; and several orders of monks wore a knife whose

handle was made of the wood of the agnus castus
as a sure means of rendering their hearts insensible
In Dryden's version of the Flower and the Leaf,—

“Wreaths of agnus castus others bore;
These last, who with those virgin crowns were dressed,
Appeared in higher honor than the rest.”

And their queen carried a branch of it for a sceptre





FEBRUARY.

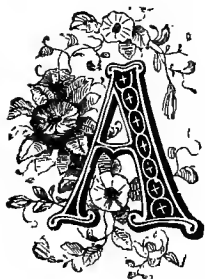
SNOWDROP (*Galanthus nivalis*). Consolation. A friend
in adversity.

“Lone flower, hemmed in with snows, and white as they.”

Wordsworth.

“Thou timid snowdrop, raise thy lovely head.”

Barton.



DELICATE blossom suddenly appears breaking through the snowy veil which covers the earth, and shows to our wondering eyes its pure cups, tipped with green, as if Hope had marked them for her own. Expanding amid wintry scenes, this lovely flower seems to smile at all the rigors of the season,

and says, "I come to console you, and whisper the return of the long, bright, sunny days."

"Already now the snowdrop dares appear,
The first pale blossom of the unripened year;
As Flora's breath, by some transforming power,
Had changed an icicle into a flower."

Mrs. Barbauld.

"Nature — deep and mystic world!
Mighty mother, still unknown!
Thou didst sure the snowdrop gird
With an armor all thine own.
Thou, who sent'st it forth alone
To the cold and sullen season
(Like a thought at random thrown),
Sent it thus for some grave reason."

Barry Cornwall.

JUNIPER (*Juniperus communis*). Asylum. Aid.

This tree was anciently consecrated to the Eumenides; the smoke of its green branches was the incense which was most preferred to offer to the infernal deities. The berries were burned at funerals to keep off witchcraft. In Holland they are extensively used now to flavor gin. The Chinese and the English like to adorn their gardens with this wild tree, which accustoms itself with difficulty to cultivation. Free, it loves to grow on the edge of the forest; weak and timid creatures often seek an asylum under its long, low boughs. The hunted hare crouches there, as its strong odor sets the dogs at fault; the thrush often confides her family to it, and fattens on its berries; while the entomologist studies around its prickly branches a thousand brilliant insects, which have

no other defence, and seem to guess that this tree is destined to protect them.

YEW (*Taxus baccata*). Sadness.

The Greeks, affected, like us, by the sad aspect of this tree, imagined that the unhappy Smilax, who saw her love despised by the young Crocus, was imprisoned in the bark of a yew. Its black, gloomy foliage, and ugly form, seem to warn us against reposing under it. It is said that its juice is poisonous to horses and asses, and that if one sleeps under a yew tree, the head grows heavy, and suffers violent pain. Our ancestors liked to see it in their cemeteries. Its wood was used for bows, lances, and cross-bows. In Dutch gardens one may still see yews clipped into fantastic forms, which recall the masterpieces of Le Nôtre and La Quintinie.

FIELD DAISY (*Bellis perennis*). I will think of it.

“Si douce est la marguerite.”

Chaucer asserts that Aleeste, a fair queen, who sacrificed her own life to preserve her husband's, was transformed into a daisy. What poet has not written of the daisy? But one stands preëminent. Few will disagree with Mr. Thomas Miller, that the daisy ought to be known as “Chaucer's flower.” He all but worshipped it.

“Love I most these floures white and rede,
Such that were callen Daisies in our town;

So hence I have so great affection,
 As I sayd erst, when comen is the Maie,
 That in my bedde there daweth me no daie
 That I am up and walking in the mede,
 To see this flower against the sunne sprede;
 When it up riseth early by the morrow,
 That blissful sight softeneth all my sorrow,
 So glad am I that when I have presence
 Of it to done it alle reverence,
 As she that is of all floures the floure,
 Fulfilled of all vertue and honoure,
 And ever ylike faire and fresh of hewe,
 And ever I love it, and ever ylike newe,
 And shall till that mine herte die."

In the times of chivalry, when a lady neither accepted nor rejected a wooer's suit, she expressed, by a wreath of single white daisies, the sentiment, "I will think of it."

"The band of flutes began to play,
 To which a lady sung a virelay,
 And still at every close she would repeat
 The burden of the song, *The Daisy is so sweet.*
The Daisy is so sweet when she begun,
 The troops of knights and dames continued on
 The concert, and the voice so charmed my ear
 And soothed my soul, that it was heaven to hear."

Dryden from Chaucer.

"The daisie scattered on each meade and downe,
 A golden tuft within a silver croune;
 Fayre fall that dainty floure! and may there be
 No shepherd graced, that doth not honor thee!"

W. Browne.

The daisy (or *day's eye*) is the *gowan* of Burns and the other Scotch bards. The beautiful "Lines to a Mountain Daisy" are so well known and so often quoted, that we forbear to give them. A few stanzas from a poem by Wordsworth in praise of the daisy find their place here.

"When Winter decks his few gray hairs,
 Thee in the scanty wreath he wears;
 Spring parts the clouds with softest airs,
 That she may sun thee;
 Whole summer fields are thine by right;
 And Autumn, melancholy wight!
 Doth in thy crimson head delight
 When rains are on thee.

In shoals and hands, a morrice train,
 Thou greet'st the traveller in the lane;
 If welcome once thou count'st it gain;
 Thou art not daunted,
 Nor car'st if thou be set at nought,
 And oft alone, in nooks remote,
 We meet thee like a pleasant thought,
 When such are wanted.

Be violets in their secret mews
 The flowers the wanton zephyrs choose;
 Proud be the rose, with rains and dews
 Her head impearling;
 Thou liv'st with less ambitious aim,
 Yet hast not gone without thy fame;
 Thou art indeed, by many a claim,
 The poet's darling.

* * *

When, smitten by the morning ray,
 I see thee rise, alert and gay,
 Then, cheerful flower! my spirits play
 With kindred gladness;
 And when at dusk, by dews oppressed,
 Thou sink'st, the image of thy rest
 Hath often eased my pensive breast
 Of careful sadness."

DOUBLE GARDEN DAISY. I share your feelings.

When the lady of a knight allowed him to engrave
 this flower on his arms, it was a public avowal that his
 affection was returned.

If left too long in one spot, the garden daisy is apt

to degenerate. The roots should be taken up in the autumn and divided.

“Star of the mead, sweet daughter of the day,
Whose opening flower invites the morning ray
From thy moist cheek, and bosom’s chilly fold,
To kiss the tears of eve, the dew-drops cold!
Sweet daisy, flower of love! when birds are paired,
’Tis sweet to see thee, with thy bosom bared,
Smiling in virgin innocence serene,
Thy pearly crown above thy vest of green.
The lark, with sparkling eye and rustling wing,
Rejoins his widowed mate in early spring,
And as he prunes his plumes of russet hue,
Swears on thy maiden blossom to be true.

* * * *

Ofte have I watched thy closing buds at eve,
Which for the parting sunbeams seemed to grieve,
And, when gay morning gilt the dew-bright plain,
Seen them unclasp their folded leaves again.
Nor he who sung, ‘The daisy is so sweet,’
More dearly loved thy pearly form to greet,
When on his scarf the knight the daisy bound,
And dames at tourneys shone with daisies crowned,
And fays forsook the purer fields above,
To hail the daisy, flower of faithful love.”

Leyden.

The following beautiful tribute is by Montgomery:—

THE DAISY.

“There is a flower, a little flower,
With silver crest and golden eye,
That welcomes every changing hour,
And weathers every sky.

The prouder beauties of the field
In gay but quick succession shine;
Race after race their honors yield;
They flourish and decline.

But this small flower, to nature dear,
While moons and stars their courses run,
Wreathes the whole circle of the year,
Companion of the sun.

It smiles upon the lap of May,
 To sultry August spreads its charms,
 Lights pale October on its way,
 And twines December's arms.

The purple hesth and golden broom
 On moory mountains catch the gale;
 O'er lawns the lily sheds perfume;
 The violet in the vale.

But this bold floweret climbs the hill,
 Hides in the forest, haunts the glen,
 Plays on the margin of the rill,
 Peeps round the fox's den.

Within the garden's cultured round
 It shares the sweet carnation's bed,
 And blooms on consecrated ground
 In honor of the dead.

The lambkin crops its crimson gem,
 The wild bee murmurs on its breast,
 The blue-fly bends its pensile stem,
 Light o'er the skylark's nest.

'Tis Flora's page ; in every place,
 In every season, fresh and fair,
 It opens with perennial grace,
 And blossoms everywhere.

On waste and woodland, rock and plain,
 Its humble buds unheeded rise ;
 The rose has but a summer reign,
 The daisy never dies."

VIOLET (*Viola*). Modesty.

Ovid tells us that violets were strewn as offerings at the Roman feast of the Feralia, kept for their dead.

"The violet in her greenwood bower,
 Where birchen boughs with hazels mingle,
 May boast itself the fairest flower
 In glen, or copse, or forest dingle."

Scott.



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"There are no flowers grow in the vale,
Kissed by the dew, wooed by the gale,
None by the dew of the twilight wet,
So sweet as the deep-blue violet."

Landon.

Fairest and sweetest of flowers! What more praise can be given? If some invisible power should suddenly sweep away from the earth every tuft of violets, could any flower, of garden, field, or copse, replace them? Ah, no! the very soul of Spring would have passed away with them.

There is no fragrance like that of the violet. A peculiar freshness and purity make it stand alone among all the odors of the floral kingdom. Shakspeare felt it when he wrote of

"violets dim,
But sweeter than the lids of Juno's eyes
Or Cytherea's breath."

The Duke in *Twelfth Night* commands,—

"That strain again; it had a dying fall;
O, it came o'er my ear like the sweet south,
That breathes upon a bank of violets,
Stealing and giving odor."

And at Ophelia's grave Laertes cries,—

"Lay her i' the earth,
And from her fair and unpolluted flesh
May violets spring."

Barry Cornwall says,—

"Dost see you bank
The sun is kissing? Near—go near! for there
(Neath those broad leaves, amidst yon straggling grasses)
Immaculate odors from the violet
Spring up forever! Like sweet thoughts that come

Winged from the maiden fancy, and fly off
In music to the skies, and there are lost,
These ever-steaming odors seek the sun,
And fade in the light he scatters."

We close in the grateful words of Langhorne:—

"That lavish hand
Which scatters violets under every thorn,
Forbids that sweets like these should be confined
Within the limits of the rich man's wall."

